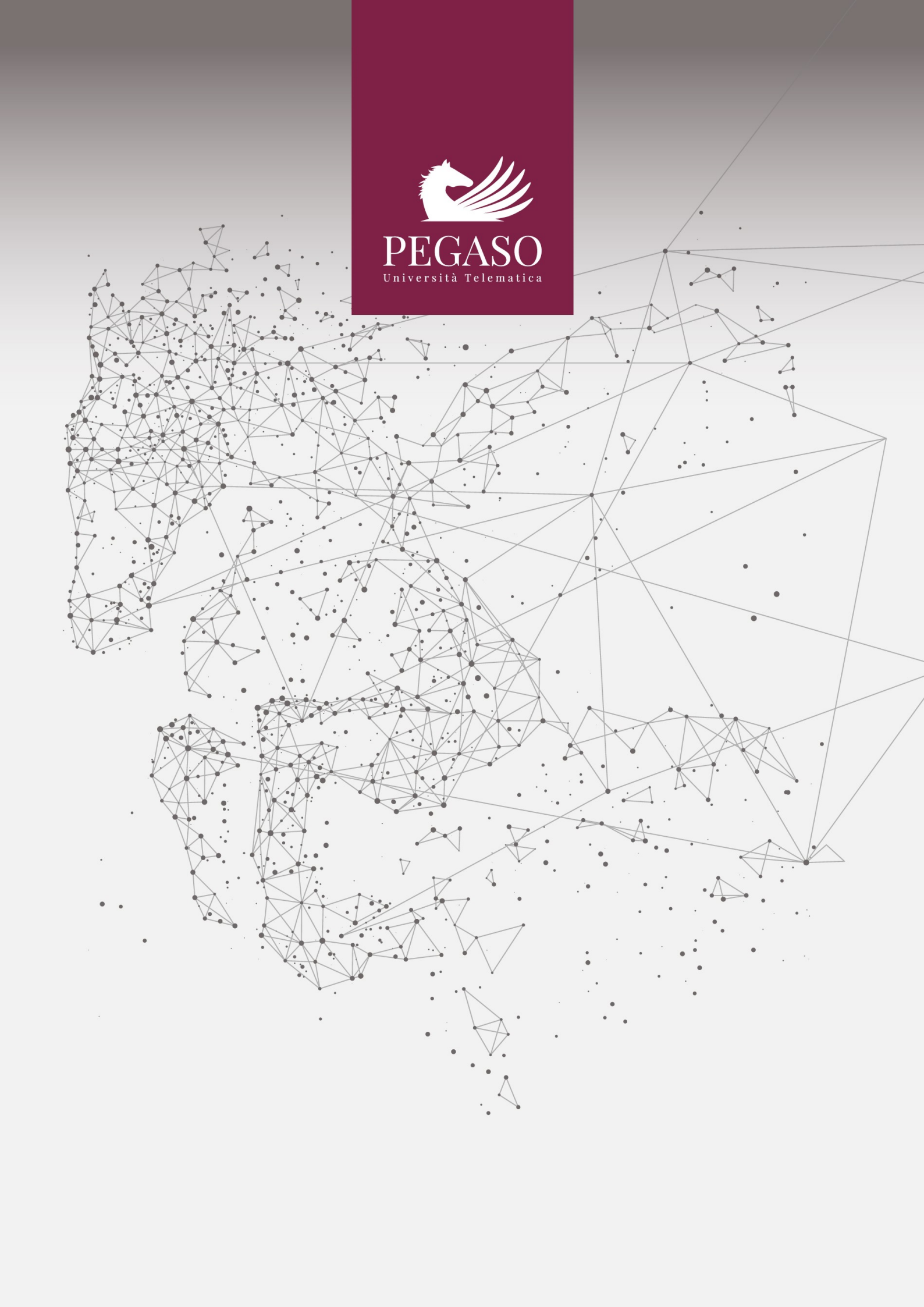

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1. Introduction to the verb do



The verb Do plays a very important role in English. It functions as a main verb which has its own meaning but can uniquely be used as a substitute for all other verbs. In its role as fundamental auxiliary verb Do is used in the formation of negative clauses and questions in the present and past simple tenses. Do as an auxiliary verb is also used for emphasis and to avoid repetition.

The present and past simple and past simple of the auxiliary verb Do are frequently contracted with adverb of negation **not**. To form these contractions, **do**, **does**, or **did** are joined to the adverb **not** and the letter **o** in **not** is replaced with an apostrophe.

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uncontracted	words joined	letter **o** eliminated	**contracted**
do not	donot	don**o**t	don't
does not	doesnot	doesn**o**t	doesn't
did not	didnot	didn**o**t	didn't

Examples:

uncontracted	**contracted**
I do not believe you.	I don't believe you.
She does not know.	She doesn't know.
We did not go.	We didn't go.

The verb Do can be contracted with **not** to ask Yes / No questions

uncontracted	**contracted** (more common)
Do you not hear the train?	Don't you hear the train?
Does she not like Tom?	Doesn't she like Tom?
Did we not pass the test?	Didn't we pass the test?

Note that in the uncontracted form, the subject comes before the adverb **not**. In the contracted form, which is much more common, the subject follows the contraction.

In **informal** speech, **did** is often contracted with wh-question words. Note that the first two letters of **did** are replaced with an apostrophe.

uncontracted	**contracted**
Who did you see?	Who'd you see?
What did she play?	What'd she play?
When did you start?	When'd you start?
Where did they go?	Where'd they go?
Why did he laugh?	Why'd he laugh?
How did we get here?	How'd we get here?

In spoken English, contracted forms are used much more frequently than uncontracted forms.

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2. Do as an Auxiliary Verb

The auxiliary Do is used to form the questions and negatives of other verbs in the present and past simple tenses, as well as emphatic and shortened forms.

The auxiliary verb Do is followed by the infinitive (without to).

Questions:

Do / Does + Subject + infinitive

Did + Subject + infinitive

We use Do to make questions with main verbs, including Do in its role as a main verb, in the present and past simple (not with other auxiliary verbs, including modals).

Did you remember to call your mother?

Do you like cooking

Can you play tennis? (Do you can play tennis?)

Negatives

Do / Does + infinitive

Did + not + infinitive

We use Do to make negative clauses with main verbs, including Do in its role as a main verb, in the present and past simple (not with other auxiliary verbs, including modals).

This doesn't look good to me.

I don't do much at the weekends.

I can't play the piano. (I don't can play the piano.)

For Emphasis

Do / Does + infinitive

Did + infinitive

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Although the affirmative in Present and Past Simple is usually formed without the use of Do, we can use Do in an affirmative clause for emphasis.

I do love his cooking.

You do look nice today!

She thinks I don't love her, but I do love her.

I don't do much sport now, but I did play football when I was younger.

In Ellipsis - Shortening and Avoiding Repetition

There are cases in which Do as an auxiliary is used to avoid repeating a whole verb phrase, this is common in affirmative clauses as well as questions and negatives.

She doesn't like dancing, but I do. (= ... but I like dancing.)

You saw Steven, didn't you? (=…didn’t you see Steven?)

That meat smells funny. ~ Yes, it does, doesn't it? (=…it smells funny, doesn’t it smell funny?)

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3. Do as a Main Verb

Do as a Unique Main Verb

In some ways Do is used in a truly unique way in English:

a. Do can refer to almost any activity, and is used when it is not necessary or not possible to be more specific.

What are you doing?

Don't just stand there. Do something.

I've finished the phone calls, and I'll do the letters tomorrow.

b. We use Do when we do not say exactly what activity we are talking about - for example with words like thing, something, nothing, anything, what.

Do something!

He did nothing all day.

What shall we do?

c. It can serve as a substitute verb (especially in British English but also in American English)

auxiliary verb + do

after an auxiliary verb.

A: Do you think Phil will come? B: He might **do**. (American English = He might.)

A: Come and stay with us. B: I may **do**, if I have the time. (American English = I may, if ... / I may come, if ...)

A: He's supposed to have locked the safe. B: He has **done**. (American English = He has.)

I found myself thinking of her as I had never **done** before.

He didn't pass his exam, but he could have (**done**) if he'd tried harder.

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He smokes more than he used to (**do**).

Do so/it/that can be used as a substitute expression when we want to avoid repeating another verb and what follows.

I need to take a rest, and I shall **do** so as soon as I can find time.

He told me to close the door in the middle of the meeting, so I **did** it as quietly as I could.

d. We use Do + gerund of another verb informally to talk about activities that take a certain time, or are repeated (for example jobs and hobbies). There is usually a determiner (e.g. the, my, some, much) before the -ing form.

Do + (determiner) + gerund of another verb

During my holiday I'm going to do some walking and a lot of reading.

Let me do the talking as I know what is best to say.

It should be noted that the verb after Do cannot have an object.

I'm going to watch some TV. (I'm going to do some watching TV.)

But Do can be used with a compound noun that includes verb + object.

I would like to do some bird-watching this weekend.

It's time I did some letter-writing.

Do as a normal Main Verb in Its Own Right

The meaning of DO as a proper main verb, when it is not referring to or substituting another verb, is defined as “to complete” and is used to talk about “work” and “jobs” in their general sense – activities one engages in which are characterized as “work” or a “job”.

I'm not going to do any work today.

Could you do the shopping for me?

It's time to do the accounts.

I did (= studied) French and German at school.

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Could you do the ironing first, and then do the windows if you've got time?

The main verb Do can sometimes be confused with Make.

Then he did a very strange thing. (Then he made a very strange thing.)

I like doing nothing. (... making nothing)

It is important to keep in mind that in contrast to Do, we often use the verb Make to talk about constructing, building, creating etc. Do, on the other hand, often refers to general activities and obligations.

I've just made a cake.

Let's make a plan.

My father and I once made a boat.

Useful Collocations for Do:

30 mph (miles per hour) Many people do more than 30 mph through this town. It's very dangerous.

Badly She did very badly on the exam, so she'll have to retake it.

your best Don't worry about getting everything correct. Just do your best.

business It's been a pleasure doing business with you.

chores I have to go home and do some chores this afternoon.

a course John has decided to do a course in computing this autumn.

a crossword She sat on the sofa, doing a crossword and drinking tea.

damage The storm has done a lot of damage to the house.

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the dishes / the washing up I really hate doing the dishes. I'm hoping to buy a dishwasher this year.

a drawing The little boy spent hours doing a drawing.

your duty He has to do his duty and look after his elderly parents.

an exam I have to do three exams and write a huge essay this term.

exercise / sport Julie likes doing exercise, especially running.

an exercise The teacher asked us to do a lot of grammar exercises over the holidays.

someone a favor My friend did me a huge favor and lent me some money.

the gardening David often spends Sunday afternoons doing gardening.

good She helps homeless people and tries to do good.

you good You should eat your vegetables. They'll do you good!

your hair Allie spends ages doing her hair in the morning.

harm I split coffee on my suit and tried to clean it, but I did more harm than good. It looks even worse now!

homework Have you finished doing your homework?

housework Let's do the housework this morning, then we can go out for lunch.

the ironing My mother listens to the radio while she does the ironing.

a job I think the students did a great job with this essay. It's excellent.

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the laundry / the washing He did the laundry, cleaned the house, and made dinner.

your nails Jenny likes to do her nails each week.

a painting There was an old man sitting on the bank of the river, doing a painting.

paperwork Does everybody hate doing paperwork?

research I'm doing some research for my thesis at the moment.

the shopping I'll do the shopping tomorrow morning. We need milk, bread, pasta and bananas.

time (= be in prison) He broke into a bank, was caught by the police, and now he's doing time.

well My sister is doing well in her new job.

work Unfortunately, Lucy does a lot of work at the weekends.

your worst I've bought all new winter clothes - boots, a coat and a very warm hat. Weather, do your worst!

Useful collocations for Make:

amends I'm so sorry that I upset you - how can I make amends?

an appointment She had toothache, so she made an appointment with the dentist for the following day.

arrangements Okay, so we're going to go on holiday in September. Let's make some arrangements. I'll find a hotel, and you can look at flights.

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an attempt I know we might not catch the plane, but let's at least make an attempt to be on time.

believe The children's favorite game is to make believe that they are kings and queens from long ago.

Certain I think the café opens at six, but let's make certain. I don't want to be standing in the street waiting!

a change I've made some changes to the document.

a choice Which job are you going to take? You need to make a choice.

a comment My mother made a comment about my shoes.

a complaint The food took so long to arrive that Julie made complaint to the manger.

a confession I'd like to make a confession. I was the one who ate the last of the chocolate.

a date I'd love to see you soon. How about we make a date for next week?

a decision I've made my decision. I'm going to go back to university.

a difference Going to the gym has really made a difference to how I feel.

a discovery When John was last in London he made a discovery — a beautiful little café in a quiet street.

an effort You're not trying hard enough! Make an effort!

an error He made several errors on the report, and the boss told him to rewrite it.

your escape The bank robbers took €10,000 from the safe and then made their escape.

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an exception Usually, the children aren't allowed to watch TV but I made an exception today since the weather was so horrible.

an excuse Why was Lisa late? Did she make an excuse?

a face The child took a bite of the broccoli and made a face.

a fire We put up our tent, made a fire, and had a hot drink.

a fool of yourself You shouldn't sing in front of everyone! You'll make a fool of yourself.

a fortune Lucy made a fortune when she sold her company. Now she doesn't have to work.

friends She loved university and made lots of friends.

fun of The children love to make fun of the teacher - but only when she's not looking.

a fuss It's okay, I'm fine, it's just a cough. Don't make a fuss!

an impression Jenny certainly made an impression last night! All my friends are asking about her.

a joke The interview was very tense at the beginning, but then John made a joke, and after that it was much more relaxed.

a journey Because of the snow, try not to make any journeys which are not absolutely essential.

a list First, I must make a list of all the things I need to do.

a loss Their business made a loss the first year, but did much better after that.

love The hero and the heroine made love in the film.

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a mess What a mess you've made! Can't you tidy up a bit?

a mistake She made so many mistakes in her essay that the teacher couldn't understand it.

Money John made a lot of money in his twenties and was able to retire at the age of 35.

a move Look how late it is! Let's make a move.

a noise Please try not to make a noise when you come home, because I'll be asleep.

an observation Could I make an observation? I don't think some of our customers like the new adverts.

an offer She made an offer on a house. She's nervous because she'll find out today if it has been accepted, and she really wants to buy that house.

a payment Hello? I'd like to make a credit card payment, please.

a phone call I'm going to go outside and make a phone call. It's too noisy in here.

plans David is making plans to move to Paris.

a point The professor used lots of examples to make his point.

a prediction The journalist made a prediction about the economy, but in the end it wasn't correct.

a profit His business made a profit from the beginning.

progress Finally, after being stuck in a traffic jam for an hour, we're making some progress! We'll arrive by 8pm.

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a promise I must study hard today. I made a promise to my mum that I wouldn't fail any more exams.

a remark John was upset because the boss made a negative remark about his work.

a reservation Could you call the restaurant and make a reservation for tonight?

a scene Susie made a scene in the café when her order was wrong. She shouted at all the staff and demanded to speak to the manager.

a sound Don't make a sound! We need to be completely quiet.

a speech The bride's father often makes a speech at her wedding.

a suggestion Could I make a suggestion? How about going out for dinner?

sure I don't think I left the gate open, but I'm just going to go and make sure.

the bed Could you please make the bed before you leave the house? Otherwise, it looks so messy with the duvet and the pillows everywhere.

time (-find time to do something) Everybody's busy, but you need to make time to study. Otherwise, you won't be able to get a better job.

trouble That employee is trying to make trouble. He is always telling the boss bad things about his colleagues.

a visit I'll call you this afternoon - I need to make a visit to my granny this morning.

your mind up Do you want chocolate or strawberry ice cream? Make your mind up quickly!

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your way After the film, John made his way to a café, where he had two cups of coffee and some cake.

EXERCISES

Write questions with Do….? and Does…?

1. I like chocolate. How about you? ex. Do you like chocolate?
2. I play tennis. How about you?
3. You live near here. How about Lucy?
4. Tom plays tennis. How about his friends?
5. You speak English. How about your brother?
6 I do yoga every morning. How about you?
7 Sue often goes away. How about Paul?
8 I want to be famous. How about you?
9 You work hard. How about Anna?

Make questions from these words + do/does. Put the words in the right order.

10. (where / live / your parents)
ex. Where do your parents live?

11. (you / early / always / get up)
ex. Do you always get up early?

12. (how often / TV / you / watch)

13. (you / want / what / for dinner)

14. (like / you / football)

15. (your brother / like / football)

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16. (what / you / do / in your free time)

17. (your sister / work / where)

18. (to the cinema / often / you / go)

Complete these sentences with the verb in the negative.

19. ex. I saw Barbara, but I didn't see Jane.

20. They worked on Monday, but they……..on Tuesday.

21. We went to the post office, but we……to the bank.

22. She had a pen, but she .....any paper.

23. Jack did French at school, but he……..German.

Write questions with Did ...?

24. ex. I watched TV last night. How about you? Did you watch TV last night

25. I enjoyed the party. How about you?

26. I had a good holiday. How about you?

27. I finished work early. How about you?

28. I slept well last night. How about you?

Put in the correct form of 'make' or 'do'.

29. John worked hard and _____ his best at his job, but he still wasn't promoted.

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30. The teenagers were _____ such a noise that the neighbor called the police.

31. She _____ a payment on her debt every month. Soon she'll have finished paying it off.

32. So many chores to _____! I need to clean the bathroom and the kitchen, hoover and change all the beds.

33. Sorry, I _____ a mistake. The restaurant isn't here, but on another street.

34. It's late, and we should go home. Let's _____ a move.

35. Unfortunately, his business _____ a huge loss last year and had to close down.

36. If you don't speak English, you'll find it hard to _____ business in the UK.

37. He _____ a promise to his grandmother that he'd never fight anyone ever again.

38. I called the hotel and _____ a reservation for two people for Saturday the 16th .

39. The washing machine flooded and the water _____ a lot of damage. All the carpets had to be replaced.

40. She _____ a lot of lists of things to do, but she never does any of the things!

Translate the following sentences into Italian.

41. Unfortunately, all the students did very badly on the test.

42. Children make such a mess! I spend my whole life tidying up!

43. The car was doing 90 miles per hour on the motorway when it was stopped by the police.

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43. John went outside to make a phone call.

44. Lucy has decided to do a course this autumn. She's going to study Spanish.

45. My grandmother loves doing crosswords.

EXERCISE ANSWER KEY

1. Do you like chocolate?
2. Do you play tennis?
3. Do you live near here?
4. Do his friends play tennis?
5. Does your brother speak English?
6. Do you do yoga?
7. Does Paul often go away?
8. Do you want to be famous?
9. Does Anna work hard?
10. Where do your parents live?
11. Do you always get up early?
12. How often do you watch TV?
13. What do you want for dinner?
14. Do you like football?
15. Does your brother like football?
16. What do you do in your free time?
17. Where does your sister work?
18. How often do you go to the cinema?
19. I saw Barbara, but I didn't see Jean.
20. They worked on Monday, but they didn't work on Tuesday.
21. We went to the post office, but we didn't go to the bank.
22. She had a pen, but she didn't have any paper.
23. Jack did French at school, but he didn't do German.
24. Did you watch TV last night?
25. Did you enjoy the party?

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26. Did you have a good holiday?
27. Did you finish work early?
28. Did you sleep well last night?
29. John worked hard and did his best at his job, but he still wasn't promoted.
30. The teenagers were making such a noise that the neighbor called the police.
31. She makes a payment on her debt every month. Soon she'll have finished paying it off.
32. So many chores to do! I need to clean the bathroom and the kitchen, hoover and change all the beds.
33. Sorry, I made a mistake. The restaurant isn't here, but on another street.
34. It's late, and we should go home. Let's make a move.
35. Unfortunately, his business made a huge loss last year and had to close down.
36. If you don't speak English, you'll find it hard to do business in the UK.
37. He made a promise to his grandmother that he'd never fight anyone ever again.
38. I called the hotel and made a reservation for two people for Saturday the 16th .
39. The washing machine flooded and the water did a lot of damage. All the carpets had to be replaced.
40. She makes a lot of lists of things to do, but she never does any of the things!
41. Sfortunatamente tutti gli studenti sono andati molto male al test.
42. I bambini fanno un tale disordine! Io passo tutta la vita a riordinare/mettere in ordine!
43. L'auto andava a 90 miglia all'ora in autostrada quando è stata fermata dalla polizia.
43. John è uscito per fare una telefonata.
44. Lucy ha deciso di frequentare un corso quest'autunno. Studierà lo spagnolo.
45. Mia nonna ama fare le parole cruciate.

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